Daniel Rojas

AI NATIVE SYSTEMS BUILDER / LEAD PRODUCT DESIGNER

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SUMMARY

Lead Product Designer with 18 years of overall design experience and 8 years specializing in complex B2B SaaS platforms. I own product areas end-to-end: defining the problem, setting design direction, and shipping polished experiences that reduce friction and drive measurable outcomes. I combine systems thinking, evidence-based validation, and hands-on vibe coding to move from concept to testable prototype fast, collapsing the gap between design intent and production reality. My workflow is deeply AI-augmented: I use AI to automate repetitive design tasks, generate design options, code-generation tools, and automated documentation as standard practice, not exceptions. I write well, work async natively, and collaborate across time zones without losing momentum.

SKILLS

Core Design Systems Thinking, Information Architecture, End-to-End Product Design, Multi-User Flow Design, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Service Design, Research Synthesis, Evidence-Based Iteration, Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), Async Collaboration, Product Writing, UX Strategy.

Vibe Coding and Prototyping Cursor, v0, Claude Code, code-generation workflows, high-fidelity functional prototyping, HTML, CSS, JS front-end implementation, Figma AI.

AI-Enhanced Design and Operations AI-Enhanced Design, AI-Augmented Design Workflows, Automated Repetitive Tasks (batch image resizing and asset prep), Generative Design Option Exploration, Personalized and Adaptive User Interfaces, LLM Prompt Engineering, Generative AI (Image, Text and Video), Automated Documentation, Design Ops Strategy, Rapid Prototyping with LLMs.

Tools Figma, FigJam, Adobe Creative Suite, Miro, Notion, Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Midjourney, Kling.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer | D Creative Thinking (Mirlo.Design) *Nov 2024 - Present*

Running an independent design consultancy delivering product strategy, UX design, and full front-end implementation for US-based clients. I operate simultaneously as designer, solution architect, and vibe coder: designing in Figma and building in code within the same workflow, using AI tools to compress timelines without sacrificing craft.

- Field Service Design (ARCOS): Redesigned check-in at emergency power restoration staging sites by moving credential verification upstream to Crew Leads. Cut check-in from 3 to 25 minutes to 45 seconds to 5 minutes (about 80% faster) and eliminated paper-based tracking.
- SaaS Monitoring Platform (LiveWire): Replaced a Power BI analytics dashboard with a custom web app shell, design system and front end, with grouped navigation, tab favoriting and an AI-generated background video pipeline (Claude, Gemini and Kling).
- Vibe Coding and Solution Design: Designed and built production-ready websites end-to-end using Cursor, Claude Code, and v0 alongside HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Delivered complete multi-page sites with Web Components, dynamic modals, bilingual content systems, Netlify forms, and SEO infrastructure, from Figma to deployed product.
- AI-Enhanced Design and Prototyping: Used AI to automate repetitive production tasks, to generate and compare multiple design options in minutes, and to replace static mockup handoffs with functional, code-generated prototypes that engineering teams use directly, reducing ambiguity and rework rounds.
- UX Audits and Architecture: Conducted heuristic evaluations and friction audits for enterprise platforms, mapping improved IA flows and turning vague product goals into concrete, prioritized design direction.

- AI Workflow Instruction: Authored and delivered an AI Workflow Methodology course for senior design leads, teaching practitioners to systematize AI integration across research, diagnosis, and delivery while keeping design judgment human-owned.
- Multi-Client Product Ownership: Managing 4+ active client products simultaneously across catering, cleaning, and manufacturing verticals, owning the full arc from discovery to shipped experience.

Senior Lead UX Designer | IBM Design Studio / Kyndryl *Jan 2020 - Oct 2024*

Strategic design lead on Kyndryl Bridge, a complex B2B SaaS multi-cloud management platform serving enterprise clients globally. Owned multi-stakeholder product areas end-to-end: from research and IA through high-fidelity design, validation, and cross-functional alignment with engineering and product leadership. The platform required designing for multiple simultaneous user types with competing mental models and high-stakes workflows.

- Global Navigation and IA: Restructured the platform information architecture into one global navigation layer plus local navigation capped at three levels, shipped as a shared React component. Validated through iterative testing, achieving a 25% increase in task completion across key journeys and a 65% increase in cross-app traffic to previously isolated offerings.
- 0-to-1 Product Direction: Pitched and led the redesign of a static landing page used regularly by under 5% of users into a modular, user-centered dashboard across 5+ applications, lifting daily usage by 20% and cutting task completion time by 35%. Operated as the most senior IC on the area, setting direction and making tradeoffs without constant guidance.
- Design Systems at Scale: Built a three tier color token architecture on Carbon (Gray 10 and Gray 100 themes) across 40+ UI components, achieving 95% WCAG 2.1 alignment and reducing usability issues by 30%. Built structured Figma systems and dev-ready documentation that reduced rework across agile teams.
- Evidence-Based Validation: Ran 50+ user tests and design critiques to validate hypotheses and stress-test product direction, ensuring decisions stayed grounded in real user behavior rather than internal assumptions.
- Async Cross-Functional Collaboration: Partnered with product managers and engineers across time zones to align on roadmap decisions, surface design opportunities early, and maintain momentum on complex, multi-sprint initiatives.

Lead Designer | TrueOmni *Mar 2018 - Nov 2019*

- Hotel Next: Led UX for a fully deskless hotel across a guest app, check-in kiosks, in room screens and video walls running on one shared CMS. Designed a three touchpoint pre-arrival loop so guests arrived with a room assigned and a digital key live; guest requests were routed to staff and answered in under 5 minutes.
- Designed scalable interaction patterns for self-service and touchscreen products deployed across retail and hospitality environments.
- Built a lightweight design system that enabled 60% faster delivery by providing standardized, dev-ready UI components.
- Led the UX redesign of an interactive product selector, improving clarity and accessibility through iterative prototyping.

Brand and Solutions Designer | PetitJoe *Oct 2016 - Feb 2018*

- Delivered cohesive brand systems and digital experiences for 20+ small and mid-sized businesses, translating stakeholder vision into visual reality.
- Introduced reusable templates and documentation to increase consistency and reduce production time across web and social channels.

Co-owner and Creative Director | NUCU *Jan 2016 - Jan 2018*

Co-founded a handmade bag and accessories brand in San Cristóbal de las Casas, Chiapas, run as a two partner boutique studio. I created the brand, the product line and the production processes.

- Turned piece by piece sales into a product line: defined patterns and a quality standard so every piece stayed handmade and unique, yet repeatable.
- Set up the workshop (two seamstresses and an assistant) and the supply from three traditional textile producer groups; increased productivity by 75% through better production documentation.
- Created the brand identity and applied it across labels, product marking, photography, packaging and video teasers; co-designed the products, drew each one as a digital spec sheet, made the patterns and produced some unique pieces.
- Grew from 10 to 20 pieces a month in local sales in year one to nationwide sales and exports to Europe and the US in year two.

Senior Digital Media Designer | ECV Consulting México *Sep 2012 - Nov 2016*

- Designed user-friendly interfaces and multimedia content for custom corporate e-learning courses, working with instructional designers on course structure.
- Customized Moodle packages to each client's brand while optimizing usability.
- Produced animations and visual content to support engagement and knowledge retention, iterating designs based on user feedback.
- Directed junior designers and a developer, ensuring high-quality, consistent deliverables.

Web Content Manager | Hewlett Packard (GBS: Marketing Tower) *Sep 2010 - Aug 2012*

- Managed digital content for internal processes and HP.com, ensuring brand consistency and optimizing assets for global markets.
- Acted as a liaison with regional teams and HP partners in the USA, Europe and Asia.

Web and Graphic Designer | Algentra *Feb 2008 - Jul 2010*

- Designed and maintained websites to support branding and marketing efforts.
- Created packaging graphics and managed the corporate image to keep the brand consistent.

EDUCATION

Bachelor in Electronic Computer Engineering CETI, 2002 - 2006

Postgraduate in Design Studies Centro de Diseño, Cine y Televisión, 2010 - 2012